

School of the Air: answers

Year 6 · 15 marks. Accept any sensible answer that is backed up by the text.

1. On 8 June 1951, from the Flying Doctor base in Alice Springs. (2 marks)

Finding information. Collecting two facts from one sentence.

2. Alone or cut off from other people. Evidence: some children live “hundreds of kilometres from the nearest school” and the nearest neighbour might be “a long day’s drive away”. (2 marks)

Word meaning. The meaning is clear from the details around the word, so the child points to the evidence.

3. The radio already let people on remote properties talk to someone far away, so it could also carry a teacher’s voice. She had noticed how isolated the children were. (2 marks)

Inference. Joining two ideas from different parts of the text to explain why something worked.

4. “Students listened through special radio sets, many of them powered by pedals, and spoke to their teacher through a microphone.” (2 marks)

Quoting from the text. Copying the exact sentence that answers the question.

5. They could take part in lessons and talk with a teacher and other students, which made them feel less alone. Evidence: they could “answer a question out loud and hear other students doing the same”. (2 marks)

Inference. Deciding what matters most in a text and backing it up.

6. Changed: most schools use the internet and live video instead of radio. Stayed the same: the aim that no child should miss out on education because of how far they live from a classroom.

(2 marks)

Explaining from the text. Comparing then and now, with evidence from the last section.

7. 1. Children learn by post. 2. Adelaide Miethke visits Alice Springs. 3. The first radio lessons are broadcast. 4. Lessons move to the internet. (2 marks)

Sequencing events. Putting events from a whole text into order.

8. C (1 mark)

Summarising. The central idea covers the whole text. The wrong answers are too narrow or untrue.